CMPS 310 Group Project
Technology, Ethics, and Society in Film Media

Fall 2026

1 Introduction

The purpose of this project is for you to apply what you have learned by identifying the topics and issues discussed in this course within a chosen source of film media. It is additionally intended to assess your ability to work collaboratively and express your thoughts before an audience of your peers. As unpleasant as group assignments and public speaking may be, both are specifically required by the organization (ABET) that accredits this course and your degree program.

You will split into groups of three or four to analyze a film or TV series through the lens of someone well-informed on the ethical and societal implications of computing and other digital technologies. You may select any appropriate movie or series, but it must be approved to ensure that it contains content relevant to this course. Selections will operate on a first-to-claim basis – the sooner you form a group and select a film or show, the sooner you can lay claim to it in the Google Doc linked on Moodle. If you do not form a group by the due date provided in Moodle, you will be assigned to one. Changes to groups for this project will only be allowed under extraordinary circumstances.

For your analysis, your group must write a short report and create a presentation in LaTeX – presentations will be conducted during class lectures after Exam 3. The group report should be a detailed analysis of the key issues related to the technology encountered in the selected media:

- Your report should focus on the ethical and/or social issues encountered in the film/series – anyone can Google the plot, so provide only as brief a summary as is necessary for your audience.
- Your discussion of the issues shown in the film or show you select should be detailed – state what the problem is, why it is a problem, who are the affected parties, how the issues were addressed, how they could have been better addressed, etc. as appropriate for your topic.

Choose your movie or show thoughtfully – a poor selection will provide only a limited number of relevant issues to explore. The group presentations will each be at least ten minutes in length, and all group members must verbally present to receive a grade for the presentation.

2 Deliverables & Attendance

You will receive three grades for this project (for 150 points total):

- Group/Topic Selection via Google Doc (10 points)
- Group Report (40 points)
- Group Presentation (100 points)

As the sole exception to the general attendance policy for this course, attendance is mandatory for all lecture periods after Exam 3 when group presentations are conducted. Unless documentation is provided verifying your absence for a legitimate medical emergency or University-sponsored event, each distinct absence during these lecture periods will incur a 25% penalty to your cumulative group project grade.